reached Babur. Exactly on the day that they left Samarkand, Ali Dost Taghai surrendered Andijān.

This is how the things transpired:

> Auzun Hasan's servant went back after seeing Babur in his terrible health. The servant narrated the incident in as unimpressive form as possible. He said, 'The *Padishah* cannot speak and they are dropping water into his mouth with cotton.' This broke the morale and motivation of Ali Dost Taghai who was guarding Babur's Khānkan Gate. Not being able to think of any other retort, he invited the opponents inside the fort and signed the treaty surrendering Andijān.[*]

The truth as asserted by Babur is that there was no lack of warrior men, and surrender came out as an act of cowardice that erupted at the behest of the hopeless message conveyed by the messenger.

Now, the news reached the enemies that Babur had already reached Khujand while on the way back to Andijān. Babur's enemies stripped naked Khwaja-i-Maulana-Qazi and hung him to death at the Gate of Citadel. Babur felt his loss deeply. His lineage could be traced back to Burhan al-Din al-Margilali, a well-known Hanafi Scholar of the twelfth century. The family of Khwaja had come to Ferghana to become religion's guide, pontiff and judge. He was a disciple of Nassiruddin Ubaidullah Ahrar and Babur considered him no less than a saint. Babur, a believer in the miracles of Sufis and their connection with Allah, reinforced his claim of seeing him as a saint by mentioning in the *Baburnama* all those who were behind killing him lost everything including life too soon. In the words of Babur, he was a wonderful and courageous man who feared none except Allah. He talks about how any other brave man would get anxiety and tremors, but this never occurred to Khwaja. While enemies killed him none connected to him in the closest of proximity were left unaffected. They were plundered en mass.

Now, it was a time of regret. In haste and anxiety that had risen from letters of Khwaja and those of his maternal grandmother, Samarkand was lost and the story of the loss of Andijān had just walked in. According to Babur, it was merely ignorance towards an understanding of the situation that led him to lose both places.

Babur felt helpless. Never in his small stint as a ruler, had he been cut off completely from his retainers and his own country. He had never faced such a level of annoyance and hardship.